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Student Name:……

SPECIALIST MATHEMATICS UNITS 3 & 4

TRIAL EXAMINATION 1

2025

Reading Time: 15 minutes
Writing time: 1 hour

Instructions to students

This exam consists of 10 questions.
All questions should be answered in the spaces provided.
There is a total of 40 marks available.
The marks allocated to each of the questions are indicated throughout.
Students may **not** bring any notes or calculators into the exam.
Where more than one mark is allocated to a question, appropriate working must be shown.
An exact answer is required to a question unless otherwise specified.
Unless otherwise indicated, diagrams in this exam are not drawn to scale.
Formula sheets can be found at the end of this exam.

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Question 1 (3 marks)

The equation $z^3 - 2z^2 + 3z + c = 0$ has a solution $z = 2 + yi$, where $y \in R^+$ and $c \in R$.
Find the values of c and y.

Question 2 (4 marks)

a. Find the distance of the line $\underset{\sim}{r}(t) = 2\underset{\sim}{i} + 2\underset{\sim}{j} - \underset{\sim}{k} + t(2\underset{\sim}{i} + \underset{\sim}{j} - 2\underset{\sim}{k})$, $t \in R$, from the point $A(4,1,-4)$. 2 marks

b. Hence or otherwise, find the Cartesian equation of the plane that contains the line $\underset{\sim}{r}(t)$ and the point A. 2 marks

Question 3 (4 marks)

For the following question, the below approximations for the normal random variable Z can be used:

$$\Pr(Z > 0.5) = 0.31$$
$$\Pr(Z > 1) = 0.16$$
$$\Pr(-1.96 < Z < 1.96) = 0.95$$

A random sample of 81 fish was taken from a large pond. The average length of these fish was 41 centimetres, and the standard deviation of the sample was 4.5 centimetres.

a. Find a 95% confidence interval for the mean length of the fish in the pond. 2 marks

b. Find the value of x, if we want a x% confidence interval for the sample mean differing by 0.5 or less from the population mean. 2 marks

Question 4 (4 marks)

A mass has an acceleration a ms^{-2} given by $a = \sqrt{v^2 - 4}$, where v ms^{-1} is the velocity of the mass when it has a displacement x metres from the origin.

Find v in terms of x, given that $v = 6$ when $x = 2$.

Question 5 (3 marks)

a. Using partial fractions, show that $\frac{1}{n(n-2)} = \frac{1}{2}\left(\frac{1}{n-2} - \frac{1}{n}\right)$. 1 mark

b. Hence, prove that $\frac{1}{3\times 1} + \frac{1}{5\times 3} + \frac{1}{7\times 5} + ... + \frac{1}{n(n-2)} = \frac{n-1}{2n}$, where $n \geq 3$. 2 marks

Question 6 (3 marks)

In the trapezium $OABC$, $\overrightarrow{OA} = \underset{\sim}{a}$, $\overrightarrow{AB} = \underset{\sim}{b}$ and $\overrightarrow{OC} = 4\overrightarrow{AB}$.

Let X be the point such that $\overrightarrow{OX} = 4\overrightarrow{XB}$.

a. Show that the points A, X and C are collinear. 2 marks

Let Y be a point such that $\overrightarrow{AC} = 3\overrightarrow{CY}$.

b. Find the vector $\overrightarrow{OY}$ in terms of the vectors $\underset{\sim}{a}$ and $\underset{\sim}{b}$. 1 mark

Question 7 (5 marks)

Solve the differential equation $\frac{dy}{dx} = (2x+1)\sqrt{(9-y^2)(x-2)}$, given $y(2) = 3$. Give your answer in the form $y = f(x)$.

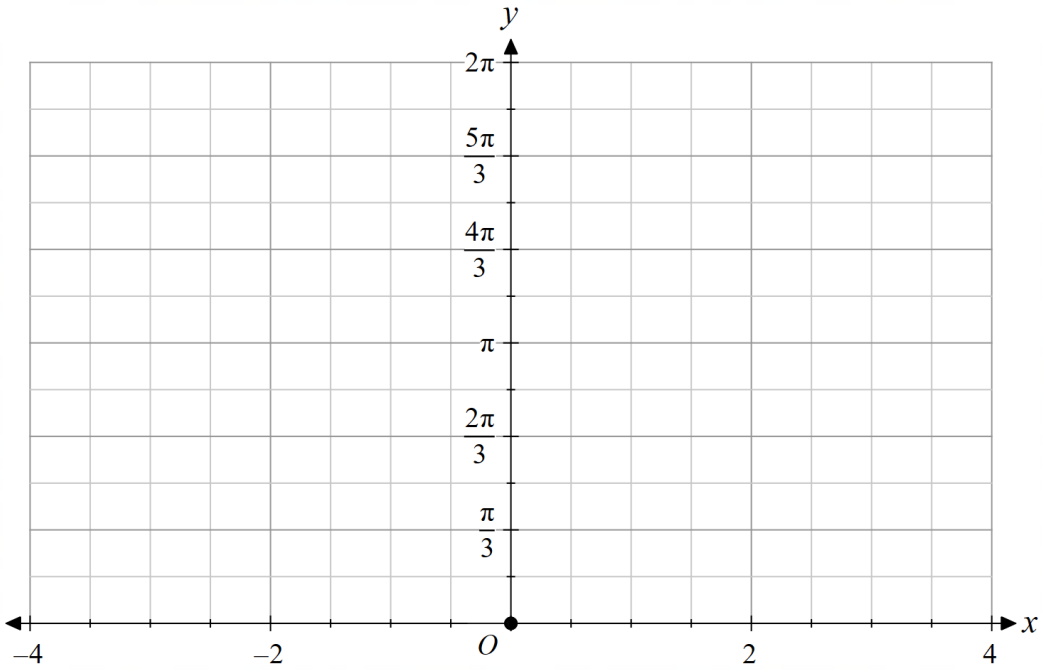
Question 8 (3 marks)

Find the coordinates of the stationary point(s) of the graph of $x^2 - xy + y^2 = 12$.

Question 9 (6 marks)

Let $f(x) = 2\cos^{-1}\left(\dfrac{x-1}{2}\right)$.

a. Sketch the graph of f over its maximal domain on the set of axes below. Label all axis intercepts, endpoints and the point of inflection with their coordinates. 3 marks



b. The graph of $y = f(x)$ for $y \in [0, 2\pi]$ is rotated about the y-axis to form a solid of revolution. Find the volume of this solid. 3 marks

Question 10 (5 marks)

Evaluate $\int_0^{\frac{\pi}{3}} e^{2x} \cos(3x)\, dx$.

End of Examination

Specialist Mathematics Formula Sheet

Mensuration

area of a circle segment	$\frac{r^2}{2}(\theta - \sin(\theta))$	volume of a sphere	$\frac{4}{3}\pi r^3$
volume of a cylinder	$\pi r^2 h$	area of a triangle	$\frac{1}{2}bc\sin(A)$
volume of a cone	$\frac{1}{3}\pi r^2 h$	sine rule	$\frac{a}{\sin(A)} = \frac{b}{\sin(B)} = \frac{c}{\sin(C)}$
volume of a pyramid	$\frac{1}{3}Ah$	cosine rule	$c^2 = a^2 + b^2 - 2ab\cos(C)$

Algebra, number and structure (complex numbers)

$z = x + iy = r(\cos(\theta) + i\sin(\theta)) = r\text{cis}(\theta)$	$\lvert z\rvert = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2} = r$	
$-\pi < \text{Arg}(z) \leq \pi$	$z_1 z_2 = r_1 r_2 \text{cis}(\theta_1 + \theta_2)$	
$\frac{z_1}{z_2} = \frac{r_1}{r_2}\text{cis}(\theta_1 - \theta_2)$	de Moivre's theorem	$z^n = r^n \text{cis}(n\theta)$

Data analysis, probability and statistics

for independent random variables $X_1, X_2 ... X_n$	$\mathrm{E}(aX_1 + b) = a\,\mathrm{E}(X_1) + b$ $\mathrm{E}(a_1X_1 + a_2X_2 + ... + a_nX_n)$ $= a_1\mathrm{E}(X_1) + a_2\mathrm{E}(X_2) + ... + a_n\mathrm{E}(X_n)$	
	$\mathrm{Var}(aX_1 + b) = a^2\mathrm{Var}(X_1)$ $\mathrm{Var}(a_1X_1 + a_2X_2 + ... + a_nX_n)$ $= a_1^2\mathrm{Var}(X_1) + a_2^2\mathrm{Var}(X_2) + ... + a_n^2\mathrm{Var}(X_n)$	
for independent identically distributed variables $X_1, X_2 ... X_n$	$\mathrm{E}(X_1 + X_2 + ... + X_n) = n\mu$	
	$\mathrm{Var}(X_1 + X_2 + ... + X_n) = n\sigma^2$	
approximate confidence interval for μ	$\left(\bar{x} - z\frac{s}{\sqrt{n}},\ \bar{x} + z\frac{s}{\sqrt{n}}\right)$	
distribution of sample mean $\bar{X}$	mean	$\mathrm{E}(\bar{X}) = \mu$
	variance	$\mathrm{Var}(\bar{X}) = \frac{\sigma^2}{n}$

Calculus

$\frac{d}{dx}\left(x^n\right) = nx^{n-1}$	$\int x^n\,dx = \frac{1}{n+1}x^{n+1} + c,\ n \neq -1$
$\frac{d}{dx}\left(e^{ax}\right) = ae^{ax}$	$\int e^{ax}\,dx = \frac{1}{a}e^{ax} + c$
$\frac{d}{dx}\left(\log_e(x)\right) = \frac{1}{x}$	$\int \frac{1}{x}\,dx = \log_e\lvert x\rvert + c$
$\frac{d}{dx}\left(\sin(ax)\right) = a\cos(ax)$	$\int \sin(ax)\,dx = -\frac{1}{a}\cos(ax) + c$
$\frac{d}{dx}\left(\cos(ax)\right) = -a\sin(ax)$	$\int \cos(ax)\,dx = \frac{1}{a}\sin(ax) + c$
$\frac{d}{dx}\left(\tan(ax)\right) = a\sec^2(ax)$	$\int \sec^2(ax)\,dx = \frac{1}{a}\tan(ax) + c$
$\frac{d}{dx}\left(\cot(ax)\right) = -a\operatorname{cosec}^2(ax)$	$\int \operatorname{cosec}^2(ax)\,dx = -\frac{1}{a}\cot(ax) + c$
$\frac{d}{dx}\left(\sec(ax)\right) = a\sec(ax)\tan(ax)$	$\int \sec(ax)\tan(ax)\,dx = \frac{1}{a}\sec(ax) + c$
$\frac{d}{dx}(\operatorname{cosec}(ax)) = -a\operatorname{cosec}(ax)\cot(ax)$	$\int \operatorname{cosec}(ax)\cot(ax)\,dx = -\frac{1}{a}\operatorname{cosec}(ax) + c$
$\frac{d}{dx}\left(\sin^{-1}(ax)\right) = \frac{a}{\sqrt{1-(ax)^2}}$	$\int \frac{1}{\sqrt{a^2-x^2}}\,dx = \sin^{-1}\left(\frac{x}{a}\right) + c,\ a > 0$
$\frac{d}{dx}\left(\cos^{-1}(ax)\right) = \frac{-a}{\sqrt{1-(ax)^2}}$	$\int \frac{-1}{\sqrt{a^2-x^2}}\,dx = \cos^{-1}\left(\frac{x}{a}\right) + c,\ a > 0$
$\frac{d}{dx}\left(\tan^{-1}(ax)\right) = \frac{a}{1+(ax)^2}$	$\int \frac{a}{a^2+x^2}\,dx = \tan^{-1}\left(\frac{x}{a}\right) + c$
	$\int (ax+b)^n\,dx = \frac{1}{a(n+1)}(ax+b)^{n+1} + c,\ n \neq -1$
	$\int \frac{1}{ax+b}\,dx = \frac{1}{a}\log_e\lvert ax+b\rvert + c$

Calculus - continued

product rule	$\frac{d}{dx}(uv) = u\frac{dv}{dx} + v\frac{du}{dx}$
quotient rule	$\frac{d}{dx}\left(\frac{u}{v}\right) = \frac{v\frac{du}{dx} - u\frac{dv}{dx}}{v^2}$
chain rule	$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{dy}{du} \times \frac{du}{dx}$
integration by parts	$\int u\frac{dv}{dx}\,dx = uv - \int v\frac{du}{dx}\,dx$
Euler's method	If $\frac{dy}{dx} = f(x, y), x_0 = a$ and $y_0 = b$, then $x_{n+1} = x_n + h$ and $y_{n+1} = y_n + h \times f(x_n, y_n)$
arc length parametric	$\int_{t_1}^{t_2} \sqrt{\left(\frac{dx}{dt}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{dy}{dt}\right)^2}\,dt$
surface area Cartesian about x-axis	$\int_{x_1}^{x_2} 2\pi y\sqrt{1 + \left(\frac{dy}{dx}\right)^2}\,dx$
surface area Cartesian about y-axis	$\int_{y_1}^{y_2} 2\pi x\sqrt{1 + \left(\frac{dx}{dy}\right)^2}\,dy$
surface area parametric about x-axis	$\int_{t_1}^{t_2} 2\pi y\sqrt{\left(\frac{dx}{dt}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{dy}{dt}\right)^2}\,dt$
surface area parametric about y-axis	$\int_{t_1}^{t_2} 2\pi x\sqrt{\left(\frac{dx}{dt}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{dy}{dt}\right)^2}\,dt$

Kinematics

acceleration	$a = \frac{d^2x}{dt^2} = \frac{dv}{dt} = v\frac{dv}{dx} = \frac{d}{dx}\left(\frac{1}{2}v^2\right)$	
constant acceleration formulas	$v = u + at$	$s = ut + \frac{1}{2}at^2$
	$v^2 = u^2 + 2as$	$s = \frac{1}{2}(u+v)t$

Vectors in two and three dimensions

$\underset{\sim}{r}(t) = x(t)\underset{\sim}{i} + y(t)\underset{\sim}{j} + z(t)\underset{\sim}{k}$	$\lvert\underset{\sim}{r}(t)\rvert = \sqrt{x(t)^2 + y(t)^2 + z(t)^2}$
	$\dot{\underset{\sim}{r}}(t) = \frac{d\underset{\sim}{r}}{dt} = \frac{dx}{dt}\underset{\sim}{i} + \frac{dy}{dt}\underset{\sim}{j} + \frac{dz}{dt}\underset{\sim}{k}$
for $\underset{\sim}{r}_1 = x_1\underset{\sim}{i} + y_1\underset{\sim}{j} + z_1\underset{\sim}{k}$ and $\underset{\sim}{r}_2 = x_2\underset{\sim}{i} + y_2\underset{\sim}{j} + z_2\underset{\sim}{k}$	vector scalar product $\underset{\sim}{r}_1 . \underset{\sim}{r}_2 = \lvert\underset{\sim}{r}_1\rvert\lvert\underset{\sim}{r}_2\rvert\cos(\theta) = x_1x_2 + y_1y_2 + z_1z_2$
	vector cross product $\underset{\sim}{r}_1 \times \underset{\sim}{r}_2 = \begin{vmatrix} \underset{\sim}{i} & \underset{\sim}{j} & \underset{\sim}{k} \\ x_1 & y_1 & z_1 \\ x_2 & y_2 & z_2 \end{vmatrix} = (y_1z_2 - y_2z_1)\underset{\sim}{i} + (x_2z_1 - x_1z_2)\underset{\sim}{j} + (x_1y_2 - x_2y_1)\underset{\sim}{k}$
vector equation of a line	$\underset{\sim}{r}(t) = \underset{\sim}{r}_1 + t\underset{\sim}{r}_2 = (x_1 + x_2t)\underset{\sim}{i} + (y_1 + y_2t)\underset{\sim}{j} + (z_1 + z_2t)\underset{\sim}{k}$
parametric equation of a line	$x(t) = x_1 + x_2t \qquad y(t) = y_1 + y_2t \qquad z(t) = z_1 + z_2t$
vector equation of a plane	$\underset{\sim}{r}(s,t) = \underset{\sim}{r}_0 + s\underset{\sim}{r}_1 + t\underset{\sim}{r}_2$ $= (x_0 + x_1s + x_2t)\underset{\sim}{i} + (y_0 + y_1s + y_2t)\underset{\sim}{j} + (z_0 + z_1s + z_2t)\underset{\sim}{k}$
parametric equation of a plane	$x(s,t) = x_0 + x_1s + x_2t, \quad y(s,t) = y_0 + y_1s + y_2t, \quad z(s,t) = z_0 + z_1s + z_2t$
Cartesian equation of a plane	$ax + by + cz = d$

Circular functions

$\cos^2(x)+\sin^2(x)=1$	
$1+\tan^2(x)=\sec^2(x)$	$\cot^2(x)+1=\operatorname{cosec}^2(x)$
$\sin(x+y)=\sin(x)\cos(y)+\cos(x)\sin(y)$	$\sin(x-y)=\sin(x)\cos(y)-\cos(x)\sin(y)$
$\cos(x+y)=\cos(x)\cos(y)-\sin(x)\sin(y)$	$\cos(x-y)=\cos(x)\cos(y)+\sin(x)\sin(y)$
$\tan(x+y)=\dfrac{\tan(x)+\tan(y)}{1-\tan(x)\tan(y)}$	$\tan(x-y)=\dfrac{\tan(x)-\tan(y)}{1+\tan(x)\tan(y)}$
$\sin(2x)=2\sin(x)\cos(x)$	
$\cos(2x)=\cos^2(x)-\sin^2(x)=2\cos^2(x)-1=1-2\sin^2(x)$	$\tan(2x)=\dfrac{2\tan(x)}{1-\tan^2(x)}$
$\sin^2(ax)=\dfrac{1}{2}\left(1-\cos(2ax)\right)$	$\cos^2(ax)=\dfrac{1}{2}\left(1+\cos(2ax)\right)$

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End of Formula Sheet